

Logic in Computer Science
Problem Sheet 2: Proof Strategies
August 24, 2025

1. Suppose that U_1 and U_2 are nonempty sets and $U_1 \times U_2 \subseteq U_2 \times U_1$. Show that $U_1 = U_2$.
Suggestion: show that $U_1 \subseteq U_2$ and $U_2 \subseteq U_1$, using proof by contradiction in each case.
2. Prove the following statement using contra-positive method:
For all natural numbers p , if p is a prime number, then $\sqrt{p}$ is an irrational number.
3. Consider the following induction “proof” that all sheep in a flock are the same color:
Base case: One sheep. It is clearly the same color as itself.
Induction step: Let n be an arbitrary natural number. Induction hypothesis: Any flock of n sheeps are same color. Now consider A flock of $n + 1$ sheeps. Take a sheep, a , out of the flock. The remaining n are all the same color by induction hypothesis. Now put sheep a back in the flock, and take out a different sheep, b . By induction hypothesis, the n sheep (now with a in their group) are all the same color. Therefore, a is the same color as all the other sheep; hence, all the sheep in the flock are the same color.
What is wrong with this “proof”?
4. Suppose A is a *wff* which doesn't use any negation symbol.
 - (a) Show that the length of A is odd.
 - (b) Show that more than a quarter of the symbols are atomic proposition symbols.
5. Show that for every well formed formula A , every proper prefix B of A , number of left parenthesis in B is less than number of right parenthesis in B .
6. Let c be a number of places at which binary connectives ($\wedge, \vee, \rightarrow, \leftrightarrow$) occur in a wff A and s be the number of places at which atomic proposition symbols occur in A . Prove that $s = c + 1$.
For example, c and s are 6 and 7 respectively for the formula $((p_1 \wedge p_2) \rightarrow p_3) \leftrightarrow ((p_1 \rightarrow p_2) \vee (p_1 \rightarrow p_3))$.
7. A island is inhabited by two groups of people, the knights, who never lie and the knaves who always lie. A traveler comes across one the inhabitant and he says to the traveler, “This is not the first time I have said what I am now saying”. What is the type of the inhabitant?